SAMU - Rwanda Biomedical Centre

SAMU Roster

User manual

For the PHTL

About this manual

This manual explains, screen by screen, what the PHTL does in SAMU Roster: building the medical crew part of the roster, reviewing it and handling crew changes and shortages.

In this manual

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2. Signing in and getting around
3. Generating the roster
4. How a roster moves from draft to published
5. Checking and submitting a roster
6. Changes after the roster exists
7. Reading the roster board
8. If something goes wrong

Version 1 - 24 October 2026 - This manual covers only what this role does.

Your role

As **PHTL** you build and look after the **medical crew** part of the roster, including the medical staff who help cover the Regulation desk. Drivers and the dispatch desk are not touched by what you do.

> **TIP** The screenshots in this manual use **fictional demo data**. The names, numbers and dates on your system will differ, but the screens and buttons are the same. The orange numbers on a picture match the numbered list under it.

You can	You cannot
Generate and regenerate medical crews	Generate drivers or the dispatch desk
Replace crew members; make a Pro the crew leader	Add or edit employees, stations, ambulances or leave
Accept a crew running short or without a Pro (with reason)	Publish a roster (administrator)
Check conflicts and submit a roster for review	Create events
Plan medical coverage for events; review command decisions	

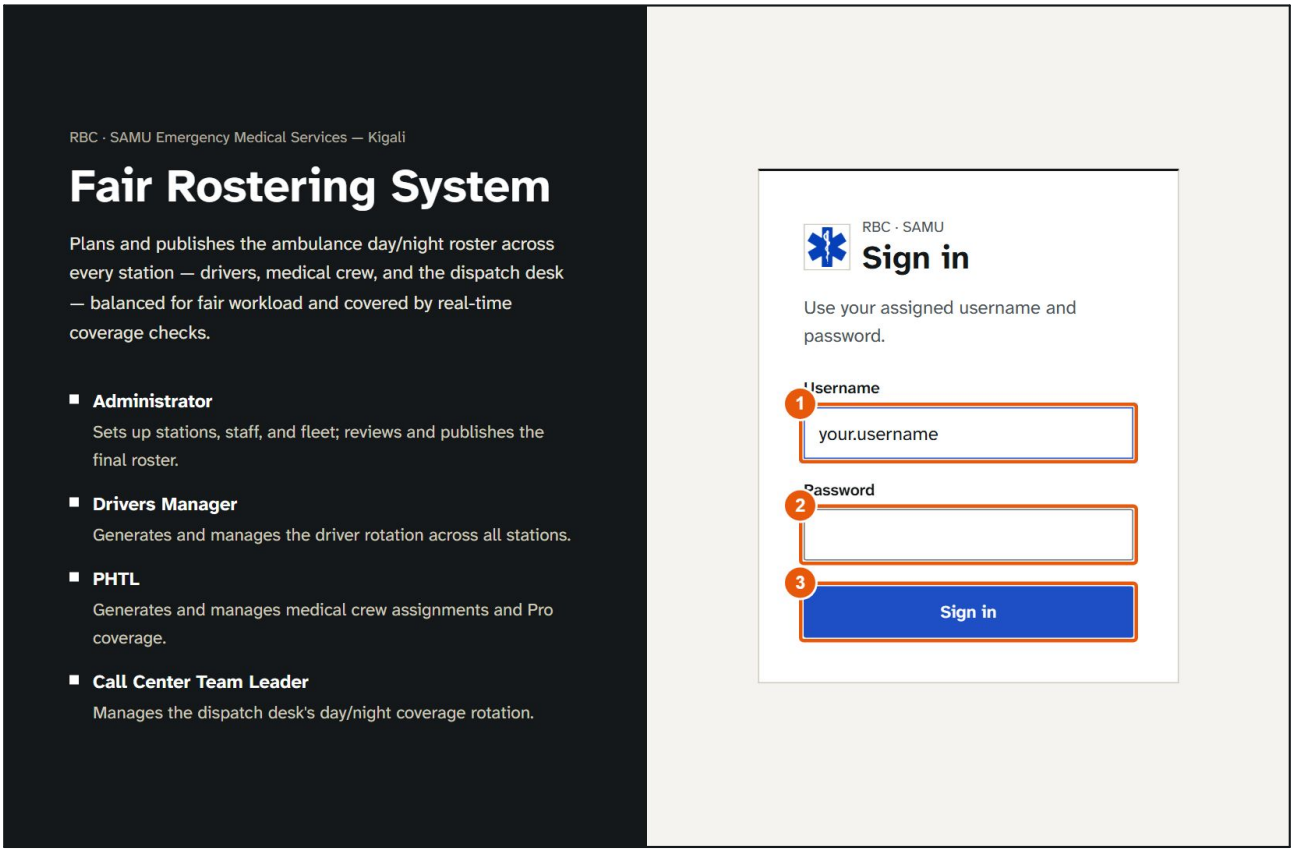
Your menu: Dashboard, Generate Roster, Roster Board, Crew Rollup, Events, Notifications and Command Decisions.

Signing in and getting around

1. Open **https://ems-rw.duckdns.org** in a browser on a computer or phone.
2. Type your **username** and **password** exactly as given to you. The username is case sensitive and can contain a space.
3. Press **Sign in**.

The sign-in page

Open the SAMU Roster address in a browser on a computer or phone.



1	Type your username exactly as given to you (capital letters and spaces matter).
2	Type your password.
3	Press Sign in.

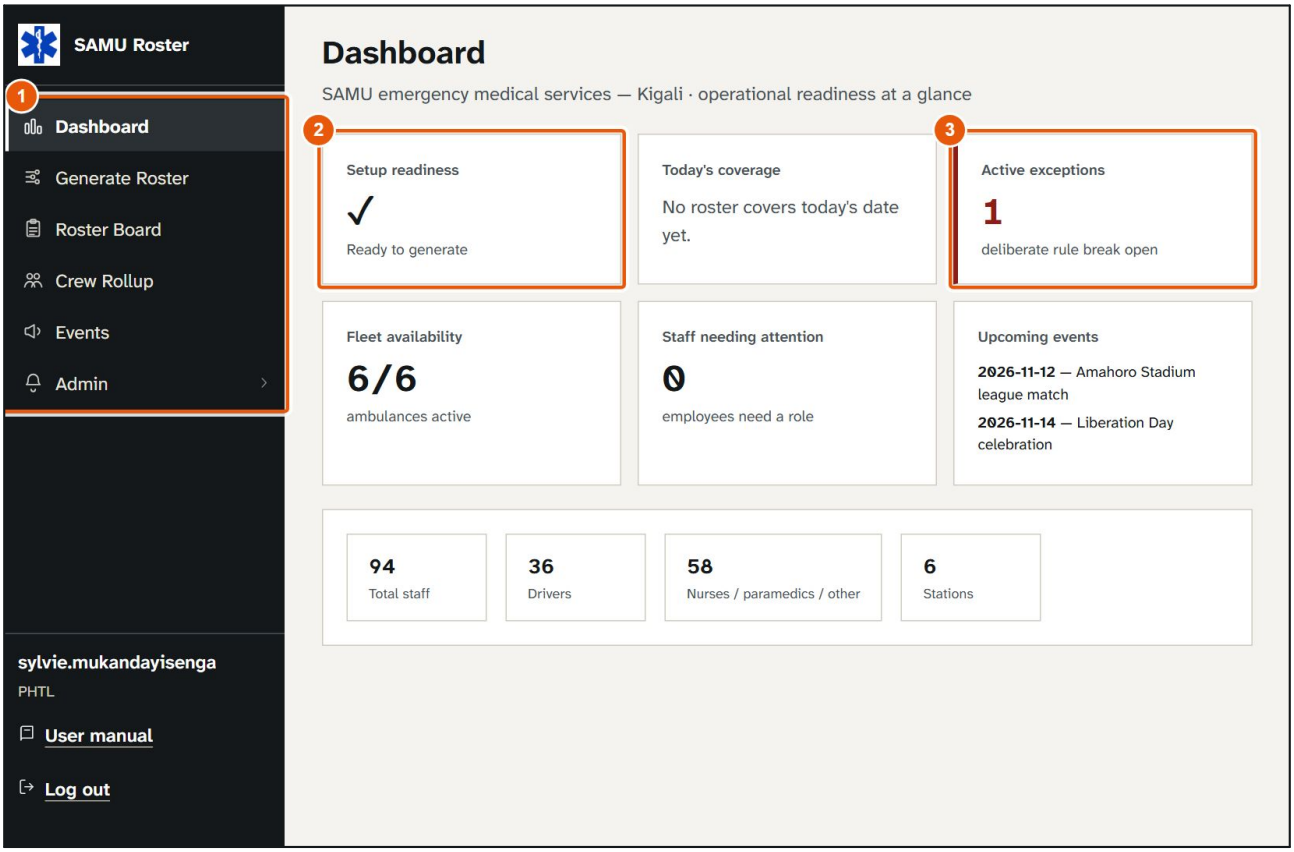
> **IMPORTANT** After **5 wrong passwords** for the same username, sign-in is blocked for 15 minutes. You stay signed in for 12 hours, then you sign in again. There is no way to change your own password in the app: ask the administrator to set a new one.

The Dashboard and your menu

After signing in you land on the Dashboard. The menu on the left lists only the pages your role can open.

The Dashboard

Your first page after signing in. The menu on the left lists only the pages your role can open.



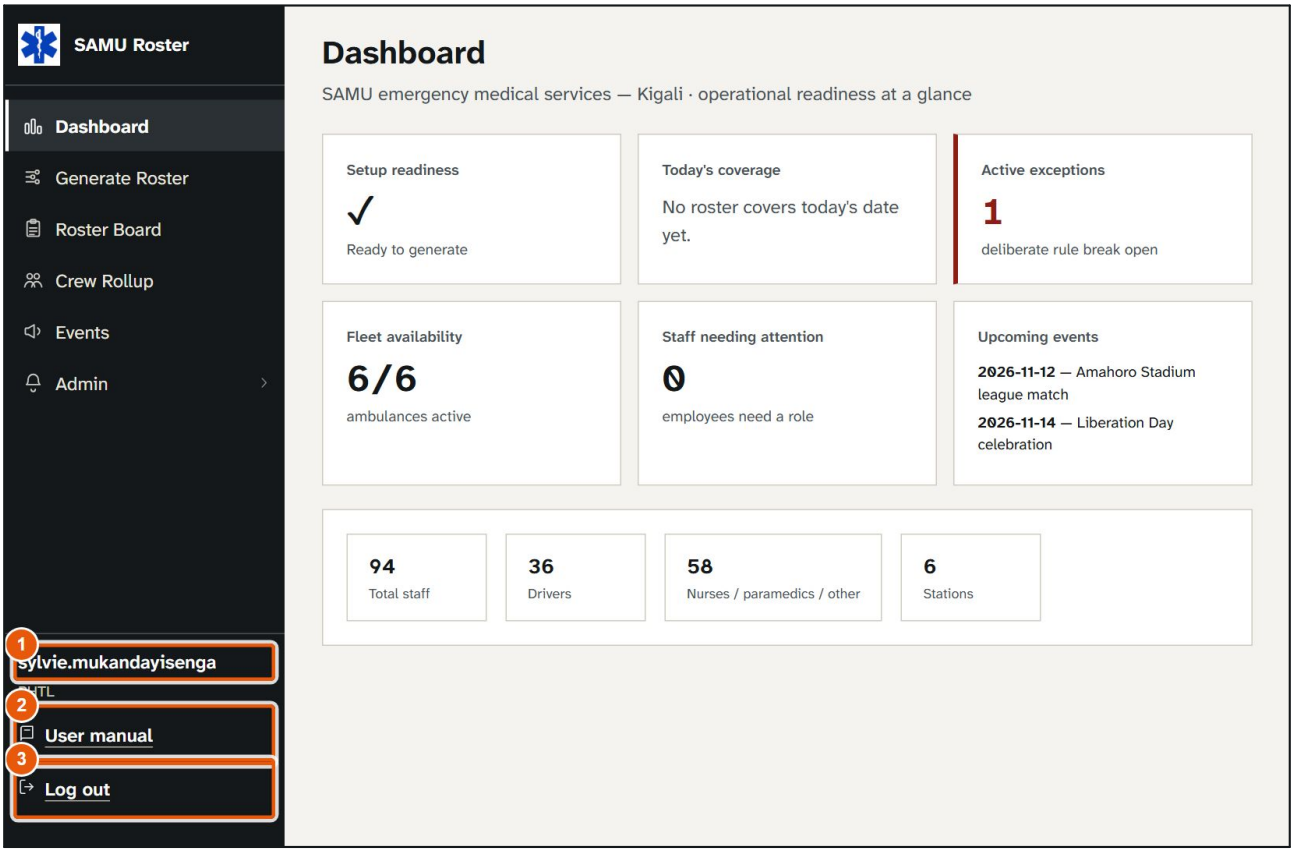
1	The menu: every page you can open. Groups with an arrow open when you click them.
2	Setup readiness: what is still missing before a roster can be built well.
3	Active exceptions: rule breaks approved by managers that still need attention.

This manual and signing out

User manual and **Log out** are at the bottom of the menu, below your name. The manual that opens is always the one for your role.

Your name, this manual and signing out

At the bottom of the menu, below your name.



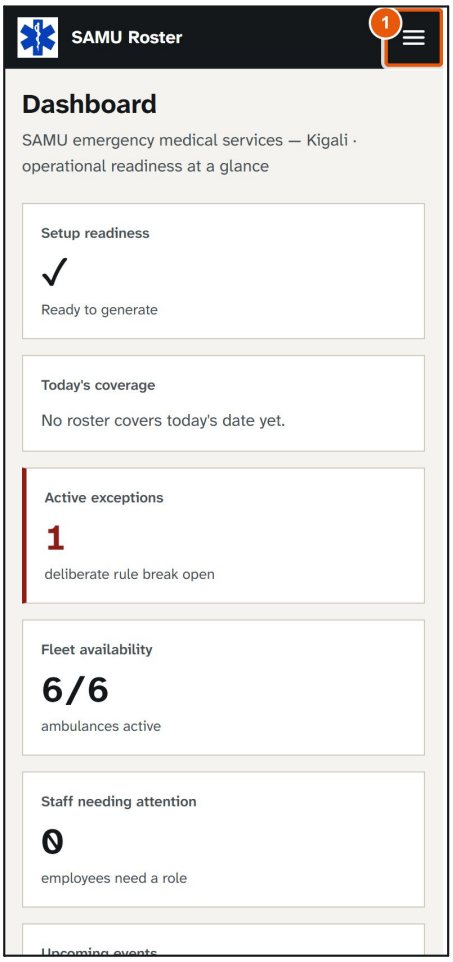
1	Your username and role.
2	User manual: opens this manual, the one written for your role.
3	Log out: ends your session.

On a phone

- Tap the **menu button** (three lines, top right). Groups with an arrow open when you tap them; tap a page and the menu closes.
- Lists appear as cards, one per person or record, with their buttons underneath. The roster grid scrolls sideways: swipe it.

On a phone: the menu button

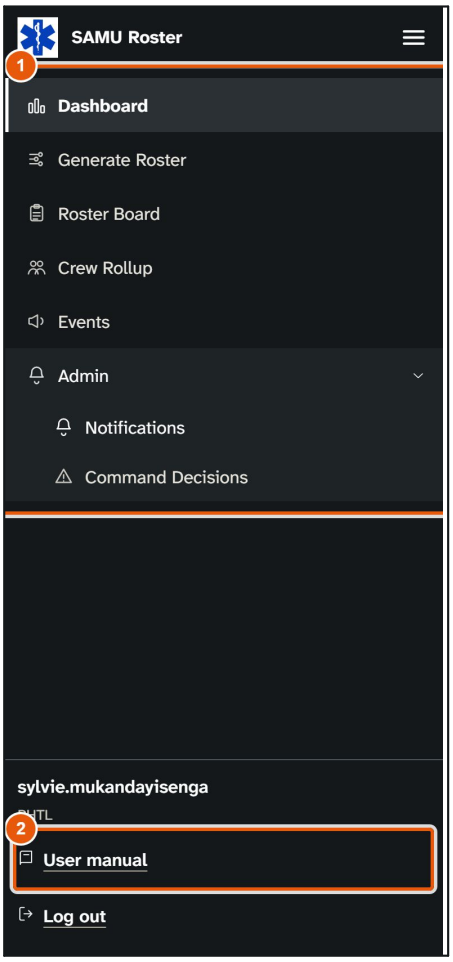
The same page on a phone. The menu is hidden to leave room for the content.



1 Tap the menu button (three lines) at the top right.

On a phone: the open menu

The menu fills the screen. Groups expand where you tap them.



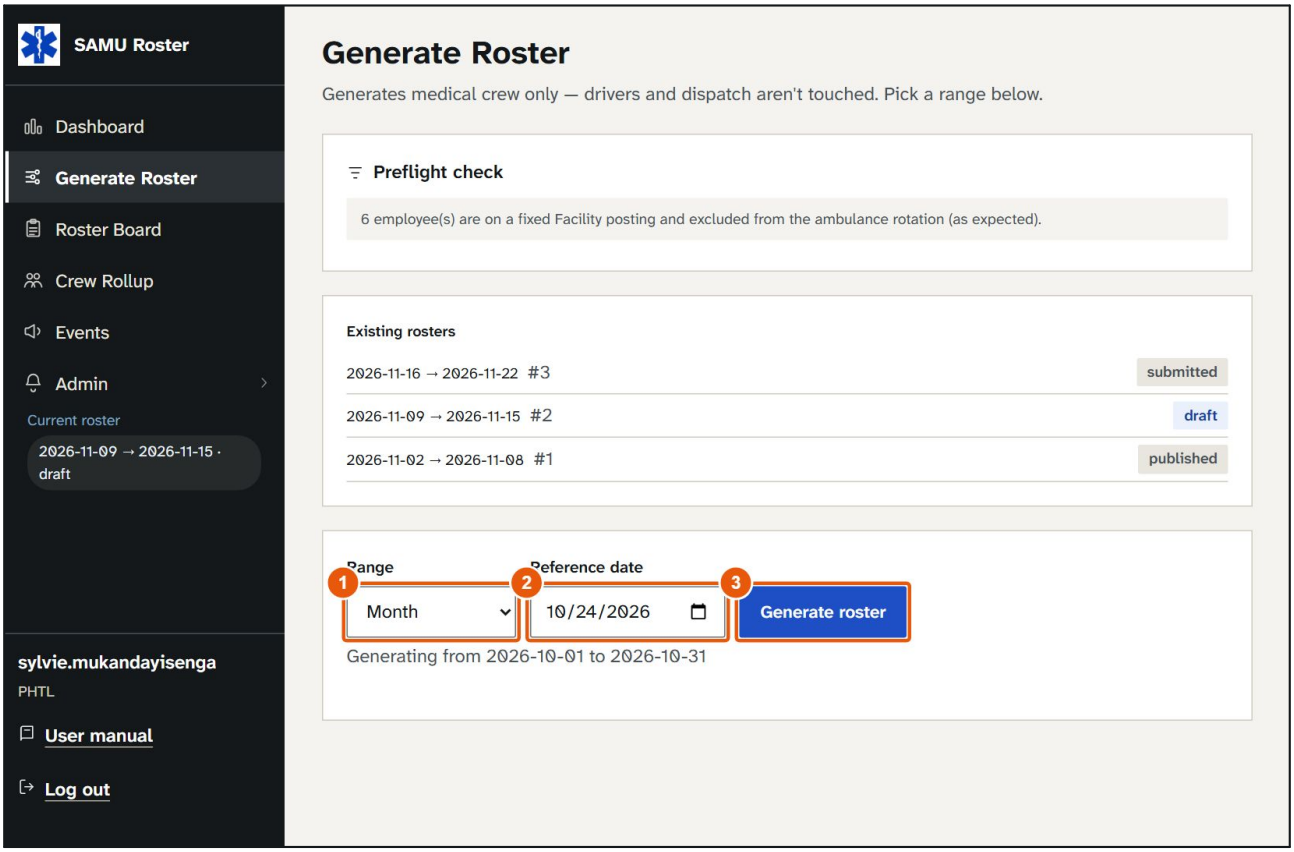
1	Tap a group to expand it, then tap the page you want. The menu closes by itself.
2	User manual and Log out are at the bottom.

Generating the roster

Your Generate Roster page says: *Generates medical crew only - drivers and dispatch aren't touched.*

Generate Roster

Generates medical crew only: drivers and dispatch are not touched.



1	Range: Day, Week, Month or Custom range.
2	Reference date: the range is built around this date; the exact dates are shown below.
3	Generate roster: starts the build.

1. Read the **Preflight check**. Fix blocking problems first; you can still choose **Generate anyway**, but the result will be poor.
2. Choose the **Range** (Day, Week, Month or Custom range) and the **Reference date**. The page shows the exact dates it will build.
3. Press **Generate roster**. The page shows **Solving - elapsed time**. A full roster takes about **10 to 15 minutes**. You can keep the page open or come back later.
4. When it finishes you see the number of assignments, an **Overall quality** score and an **Overtime** indicator, and any coverage gaps.

- **Pro coverage:** every crew should have at least one Pro. Crew leaders can only be Pro staff.
- **Specialists:** anesthesiologists and critical-care staff work only at the four middle-site stations. They are also the only medical staff who can fill the Regulation desk beyond the call centre's own people, with a weekly limit per person.
- **Home station:** staff stay at their home station unless marked *Floats freely*, and are sent elsewhere only when another station is short.
- **Fairness:** total, night and weekend hours are balanced across the whole month.
- **Regenerate** on the Roster Board recomputes only the medical crew and leaves drivers and dispatch alone.

How a roster moves from draft to published

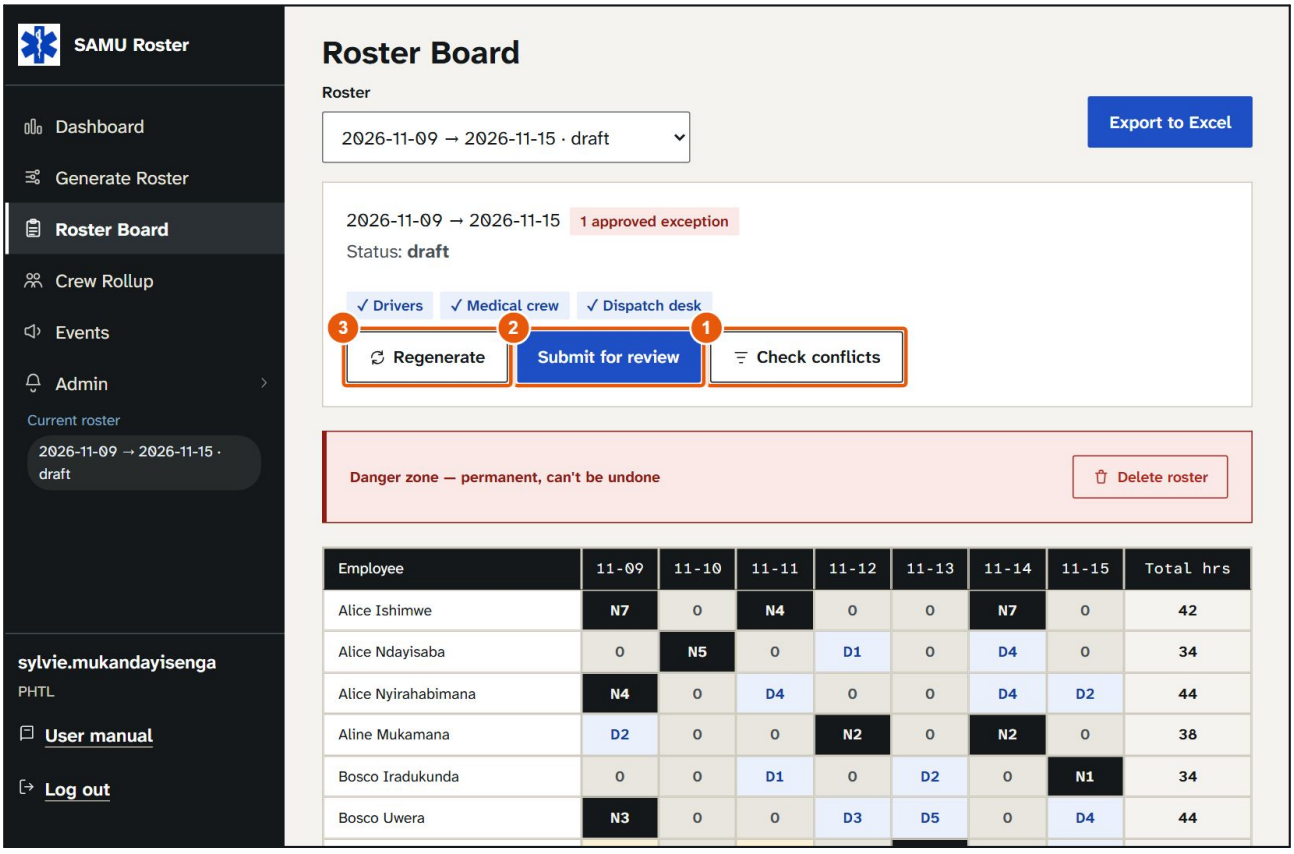
Stage	What it means	Who acts
Draft	Being built. The three parts (drivers, medical crew, dispatch desk) can each be generated into the same draft.	You, the other managers and the administrator
Submitted	Sent for review. It is locked: nobody can generate into it.	Anyone signed in (you can submit when your part is done)
Published	Final. Every person in it is notified. Later changes go through crew replacements, which notify the people affected.	Administrator only

Checking and submitting a roster

Open **Roster Board** and choose the roster. While it is a draft you see these buttons above the grid.

What you can do with a draft roster

These buttons appear above the grid while the roster is a draft.

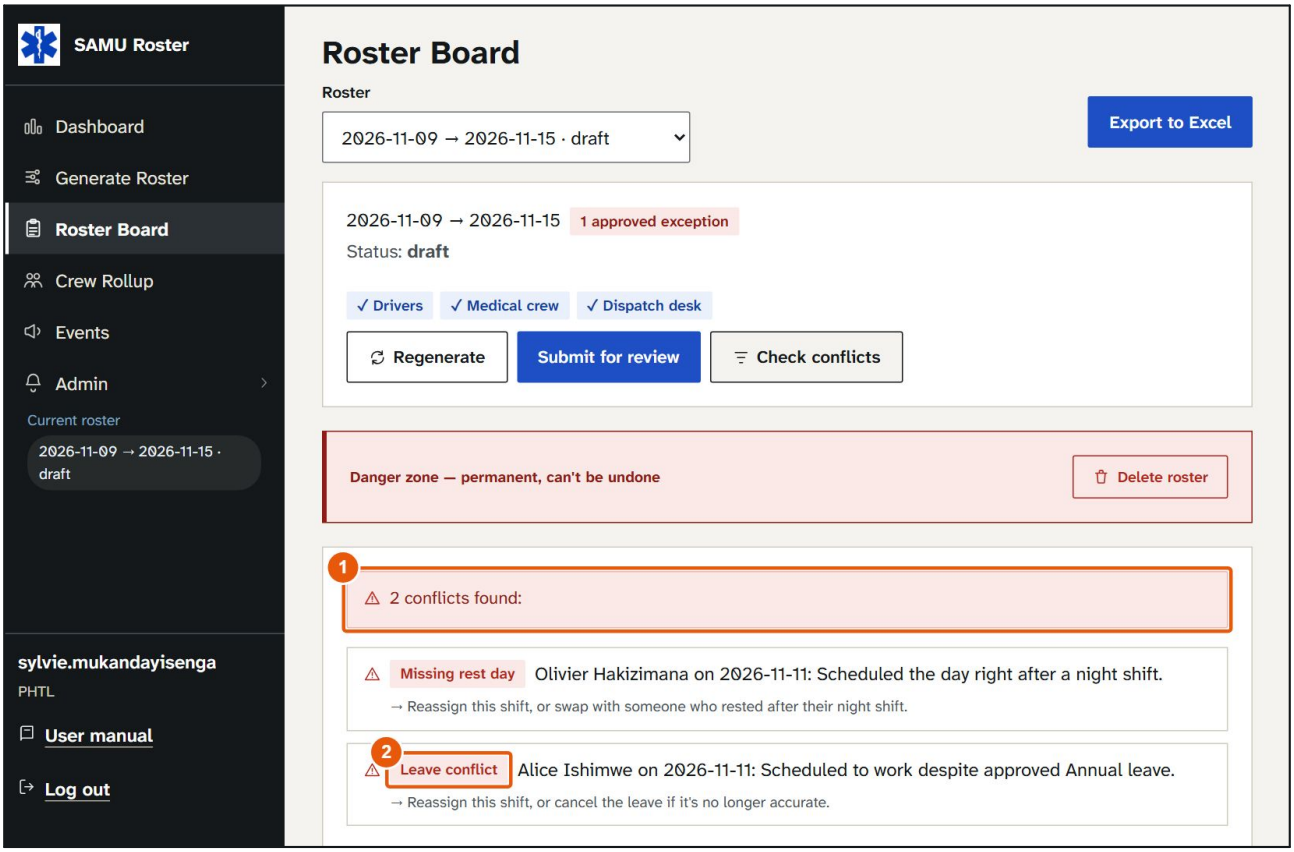


1	Check conflicts: lists anything that would block publishing.
2	Submit for review: sends the roster on when your part is ready.
3	Regenerate: rebuilds only your part of this draft.

Check conflicts lists everything that would block publishing: a missing rest day, a person scheduled while inactive, a night shift for someone not cleared for nights, a leave day that was overridden, a crew with no Pro, or an ambulance that is not in service. Each line says how to fix it.

Check conflicts

Each line says what is wrong and how to fix it. Items marked Approved exception were signed off by a manager and do not block publishing.



1	The headline: how many conflicts and approved exceptions were found.
2	A conflict that blocks publishing: it names the person, the day and how to fix it.

An item marked **Approved exception** was a deliberate rule break signed off by a manager, with a reason. It does not block publishing.

> **NOTE** You see medical staff only on the board. When your part is ready, press **Submit for review**.

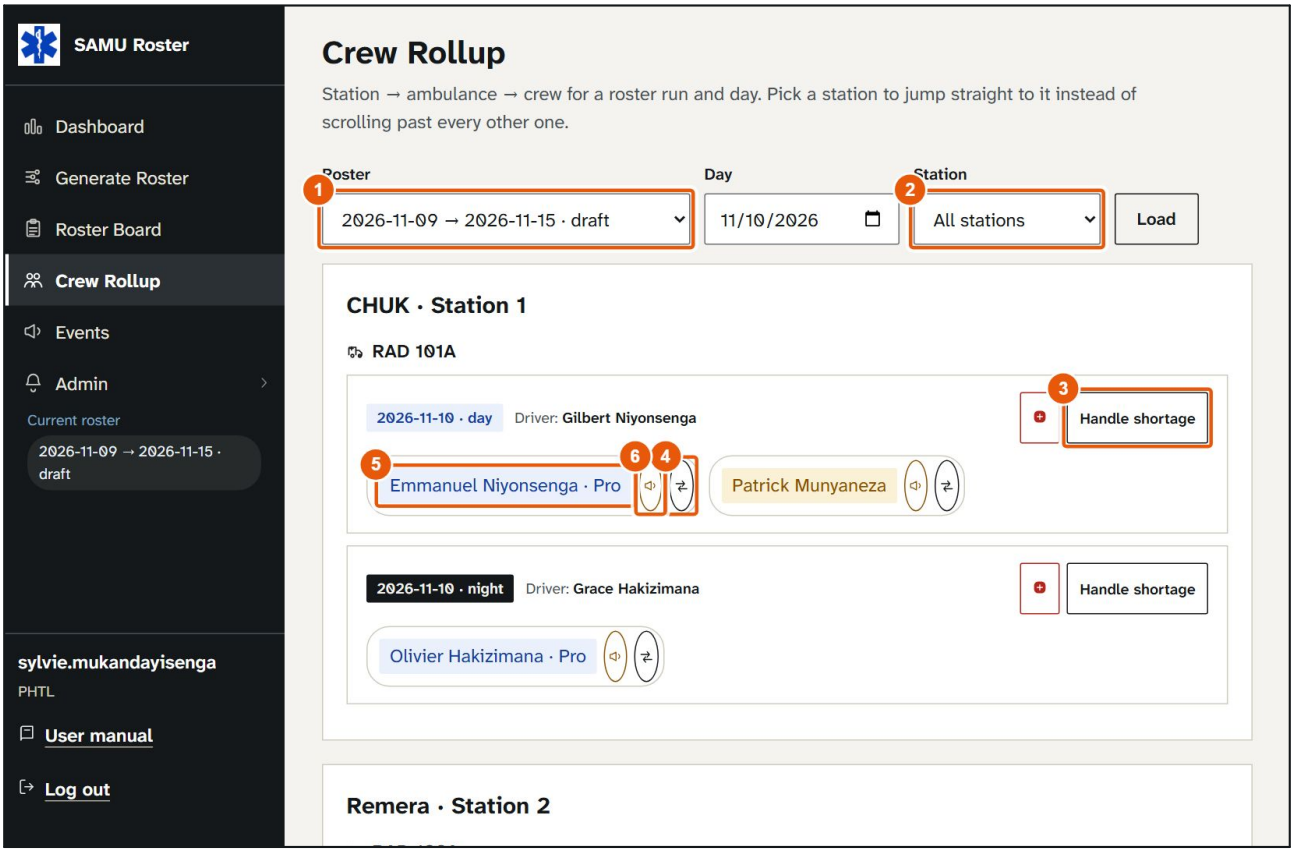
Changes after the roster exists

Crew Rollup: see and change a crew

Crew Operations > Crew Rollup shows station, ambulance and crew for one roster and one day. Choose the station to jump to it.

Crew Rollup

Station, ambulance and crew for one roster and one day.



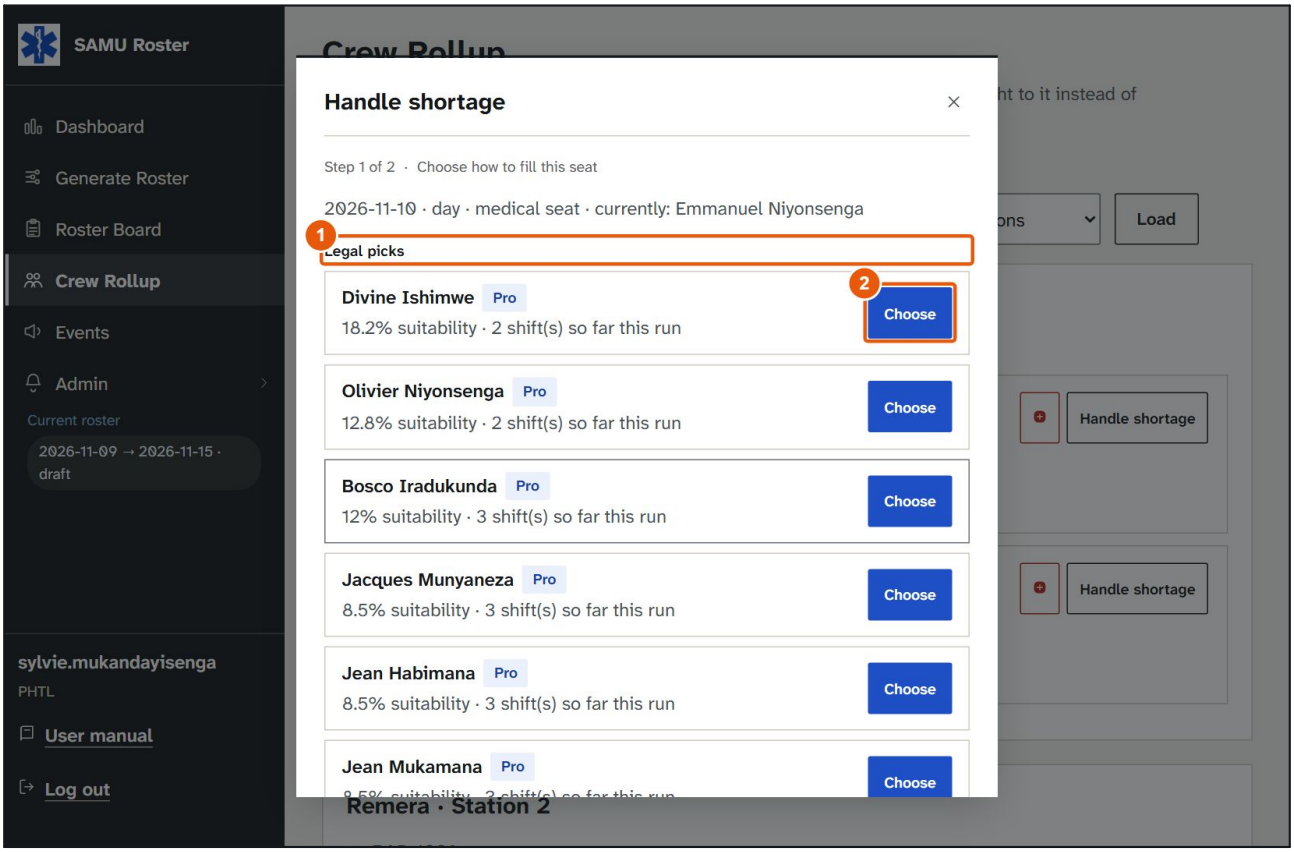
1	Choose the roster.
2	Choose the station to jump to it.
3	Handle shortage on the driver: replace the driver or accept the gap.
4	The swap button next to a crew member: replace that person or accept a short crew.
5	Click a Pro's name to make them crew leader.
6	The calendar-style button: pull this person off the crew for an event.

Replacing someone or accepting a gap: Handle shortage

1. Open **Crew Rollup**, choose the roster and the day, then pick the station. Each ambulance shift is a card.
2. Press the **swap button** next to the crew member (hover text: *Handle shortage*). A window opens: **Choose how to fill this seat**.
3. Under **Legal picks**, choose a person. Candidates are ranked by fairness, least-loaded first. Press **Confirm crew replacement**. Both people are notified if the roster is already published.
4. If nobody is legal, **Risky picks - needs an override** lists people who would break a protected rule (for example a rest day or Pro coverage). Choose a reason, write a justification and type **OVERRIDE** to confirm.
5. If nobody can be found, under **Or: leave this crew short** press **Approve this crew to run short**. Choose a reason and write a justification. Nobody is moved; the gap is accepted and logged.

Handle shortage: choose how to fill the seat

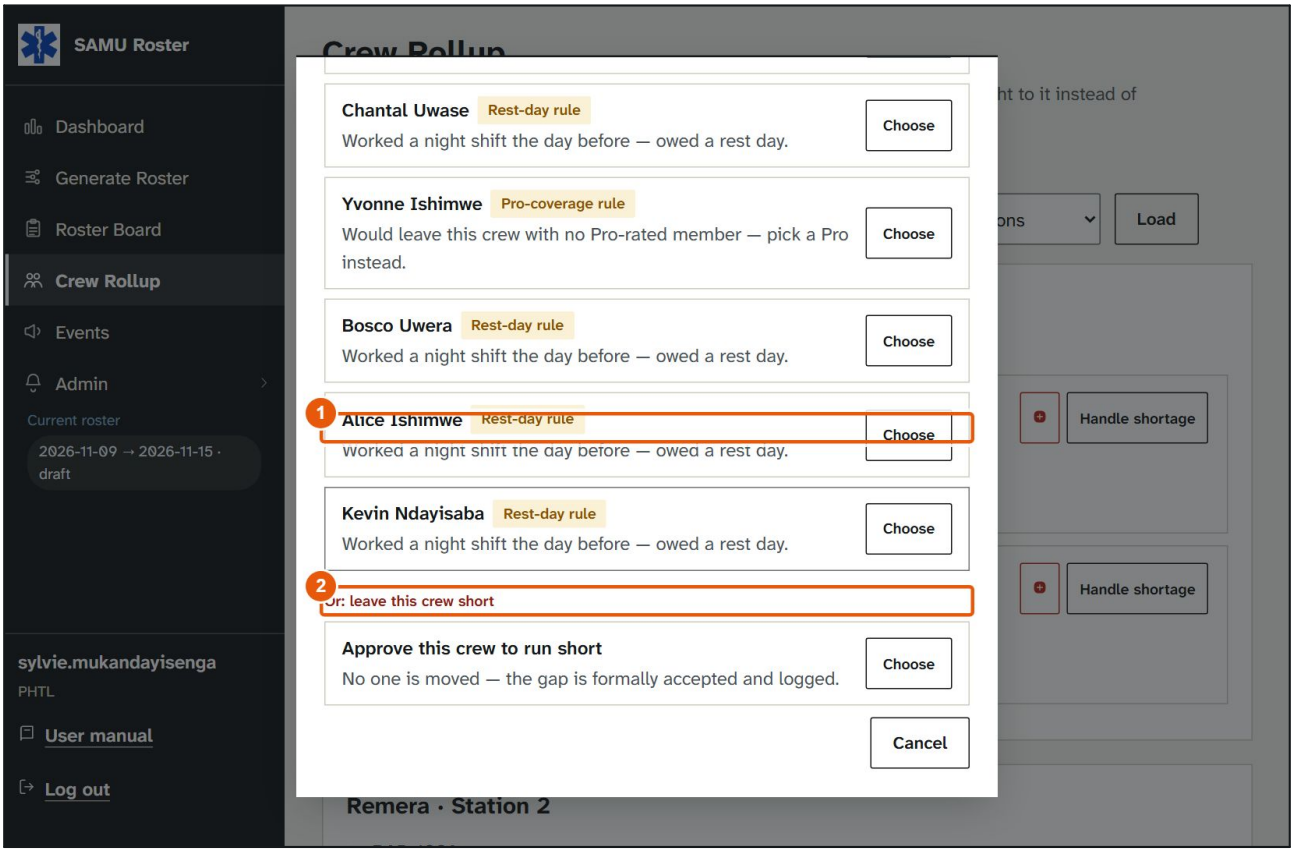
The window opens on the legal picks, ranked by fairness. Scroll down for the other two options.



1	Legal picks: people who break no rule, ranked by fairness (least-loaded first).
2	Choose a person, then confirm the replacement in the next step.

Handle shortage: risky picks, or leave the crew short

Further down the same window.



1	Risky picks - needs an override: people who would break a protected rule, such as a rest day. You must give a reason, write a justification and type OVERRIDE to confirm.
2	Or: leave this crew short. Nobody is moved; the gap is accepted and logged with your reason.

> **IMPORTANT** Every risky pick and every accepted shortage is recorded under **Command Decisions** with your name, the reason and the justification. Safety-related ones are reviewed by the administrator.

Crew leader and pulling people for events

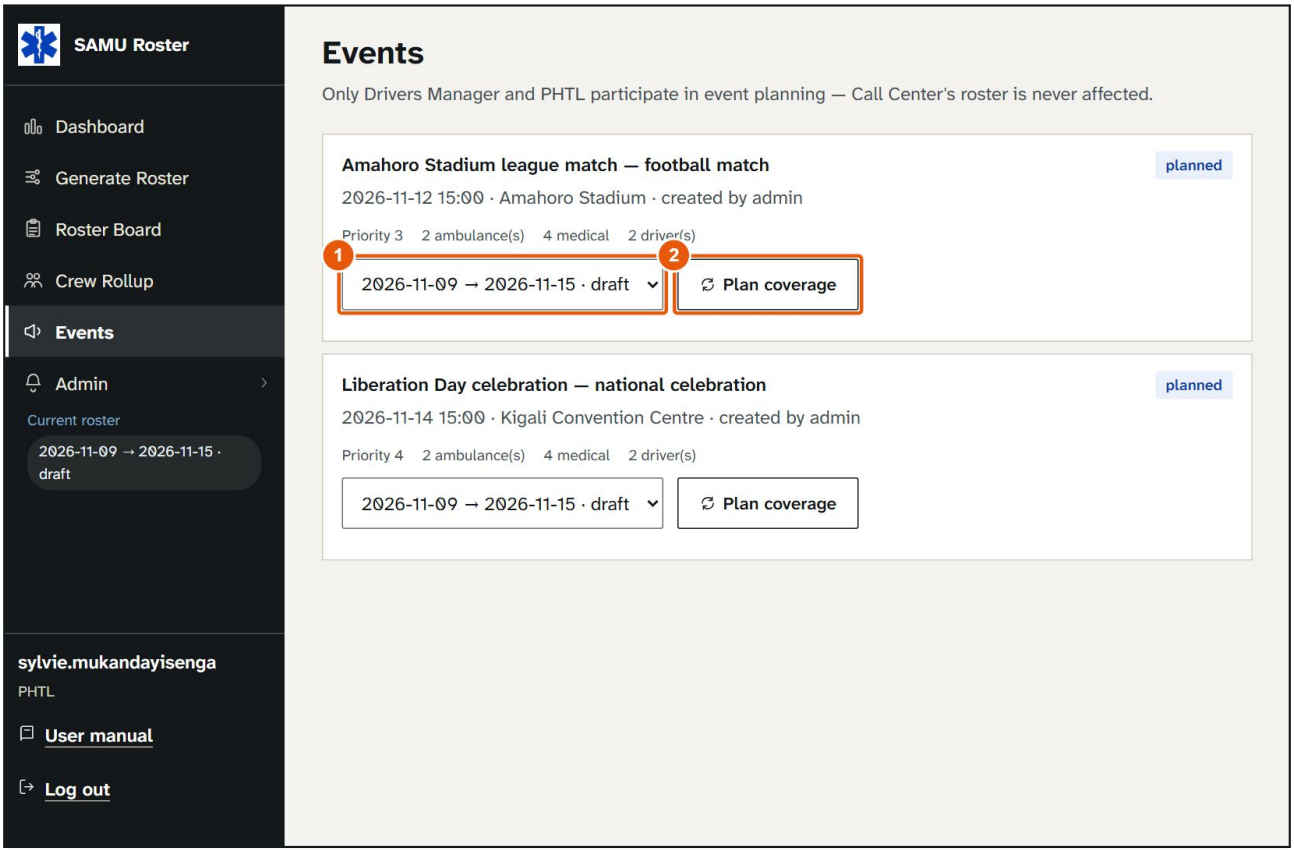
- Click a **Pro** member's name in Crew Rollup to make them **crew leader** (only Pro staff can lead).
- The calendar-style button next to a crew member is **Pull for event**: it takes them off their crew and leaves it short, with no replacement.
- A replacement who is not a Pro, and who would leave the crew without one, needs an override.

Planning event coverage

Events lists events that need extra ambulances and crews. Only the administrator creates events; the Drivers Manager and PHTL plan their coverage. The Call Center is never affected.

Events

Events that need extra ambulances and crews.

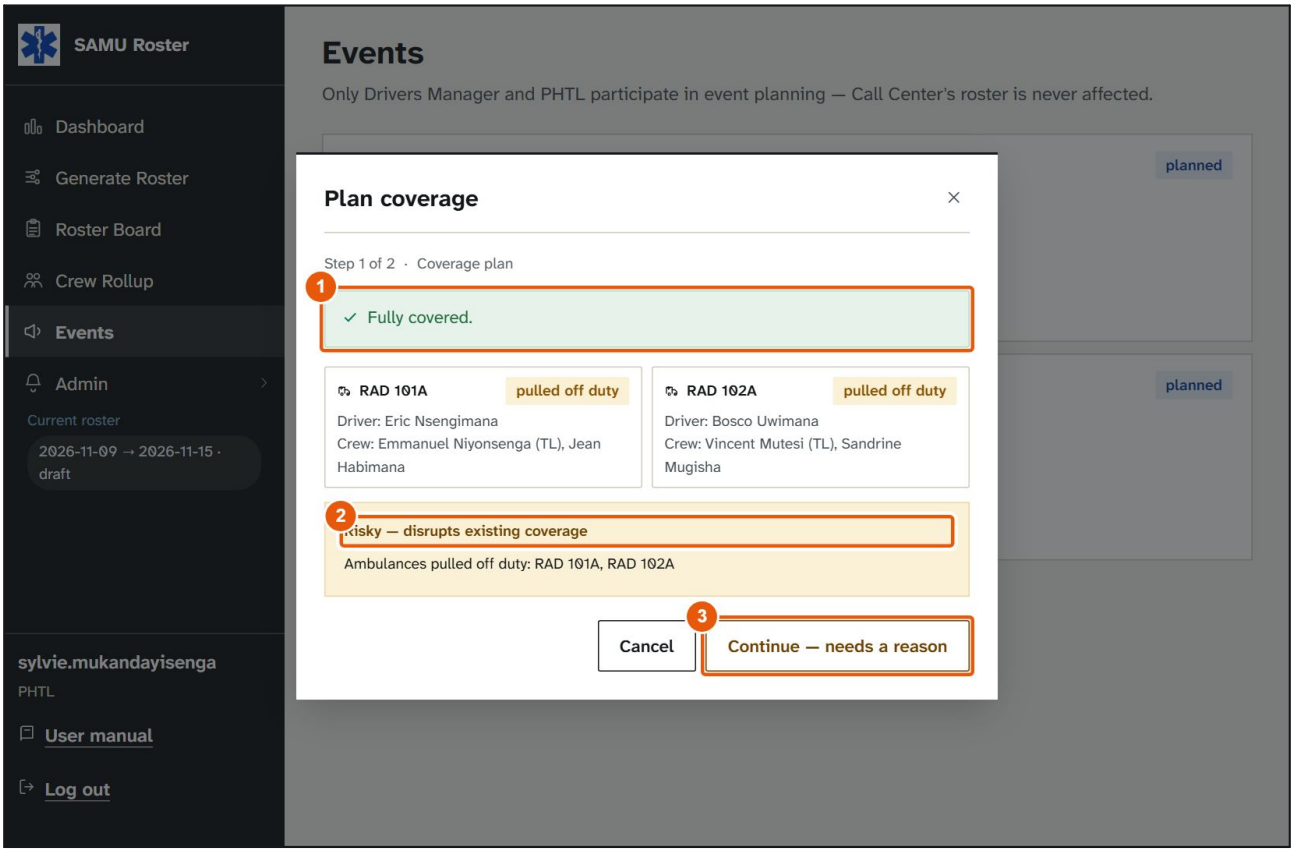


1	Choose the roster to plan against: it must cover the event date.
2	Plan coverage: the system proposes who covers the event.

1. Choose **Roster to plan against**. It must cover the event date; if none does, you are told to plan a roster for that week first.
2. Press **Plan coverage**. The system computes a **Coverage plan**: ambulances, medical crew, and any gaps (*Gaps remain* or *Fully covered*).
3. If the plan would disrupt existing coverage (pulling an ambulance, reassigning someone from a shift or from mandated rest) it is marked **Risky**. Press **Continue - needs a reason**, choose a reason, write a justification, then **Confirm & commit**.
4. A plan with no disruption is committed with **Commit this plan**.

Plan coverage

The proposed plan shows who covers the event and what is still missing.



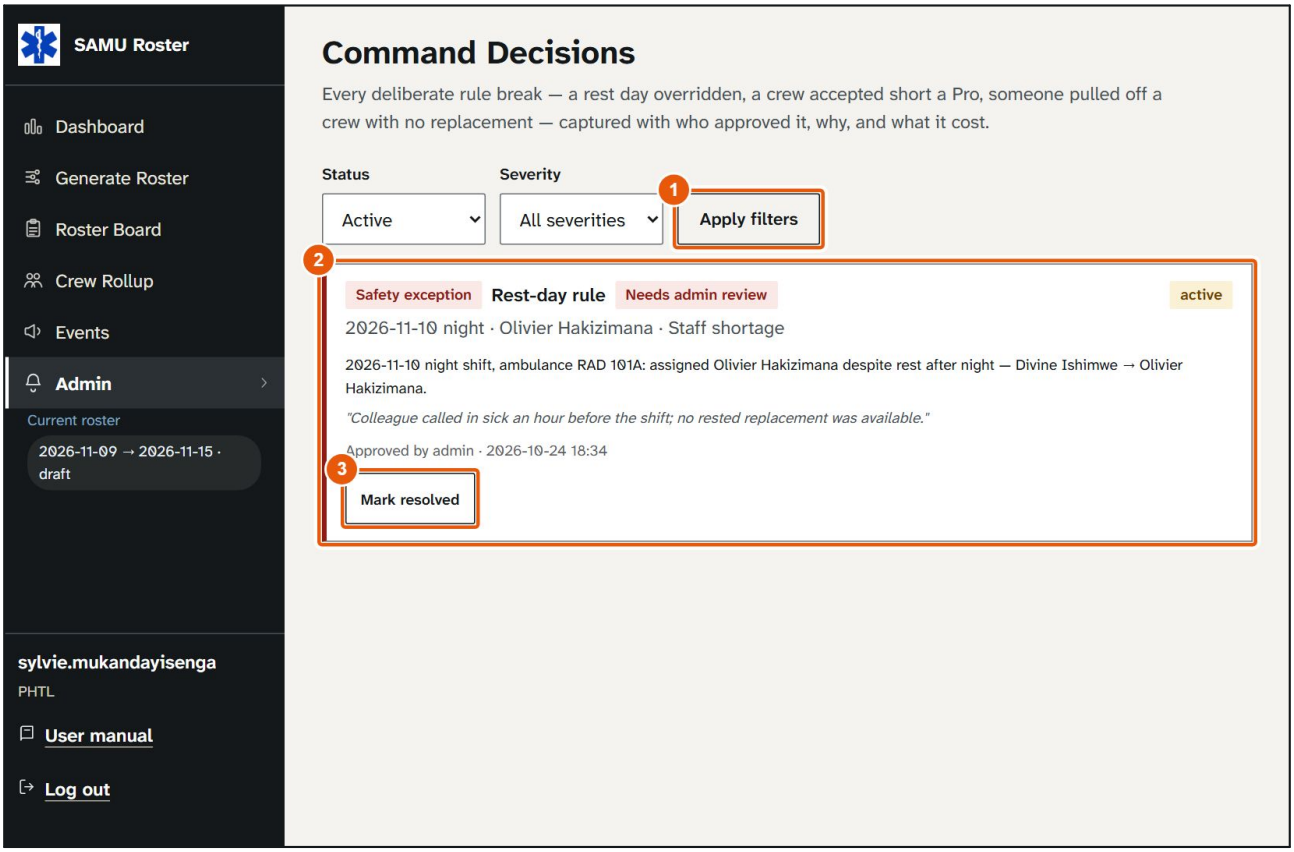
1	The headline says Fully covered, or how many ambulances, drivers or medical crew are still short.
2	A plan that disrupts regular coverage is marked Risky and needs a reason before it is committed.
3	Commit this plan when you accept it.

Command Decisions

Every deliberate rule break in your area: a rest day overridden, a crew accepted short of a Pro or a driver, someone pulled off a crew. Each shows who approved it, the reason and the written justification.

Command Decisions

Every deliberate rule break: who approved it, why, and what it cost.



1	Filters: narrow by status or severity.
2	Each decision shows the reason and the written justification.
3	Mark resolved when it is closed; the administrator also marks safety decisions reviewed.

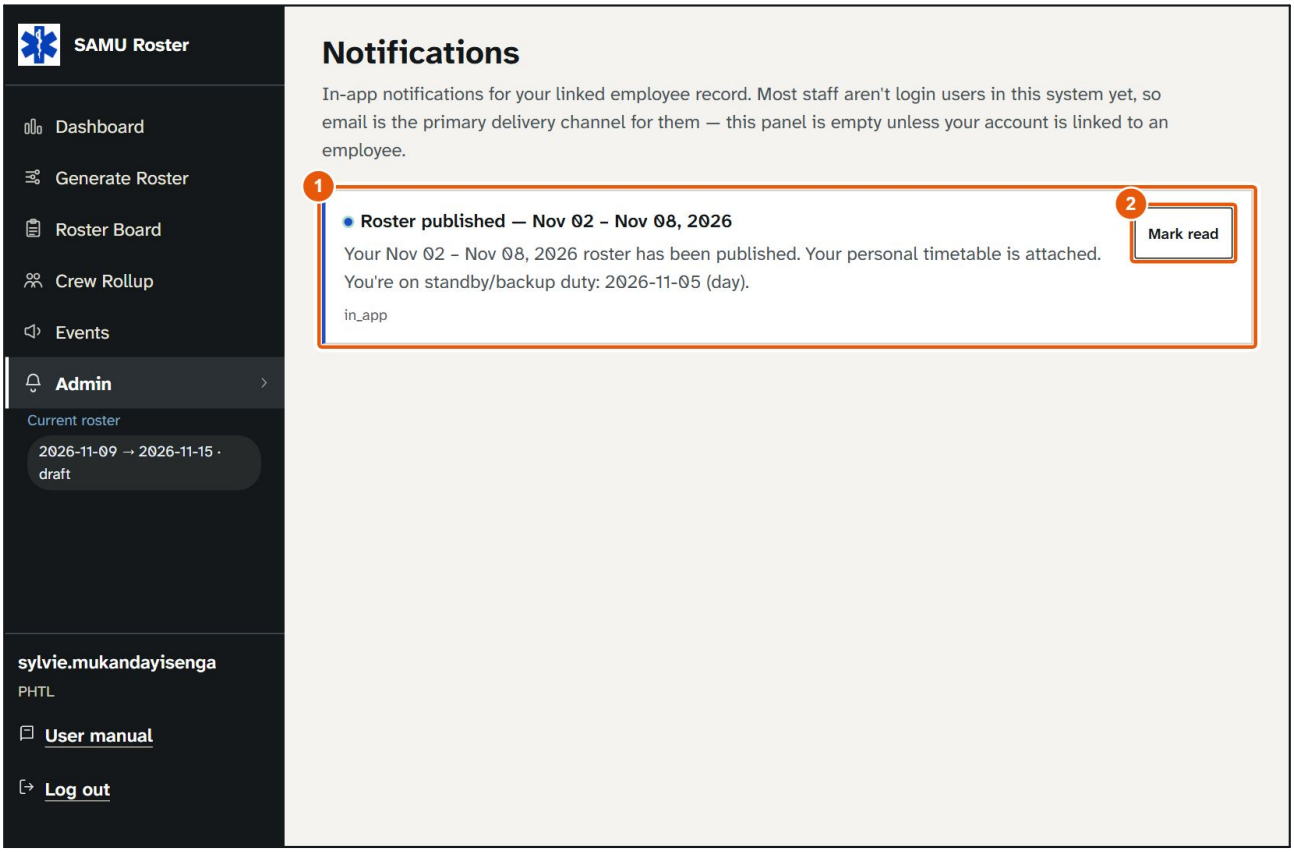
Press **Mark resolved** when a decision is closed. The administrator also marks safety decisions **reviewed**.

Notifications

Notifications lists messages sent to you, for example when a roster you are in is published or a crew change affects you. Press **Mark read** once you have seen one.

Notifications

Messages sent to you, for example when a roster is published or a crew change affects you.



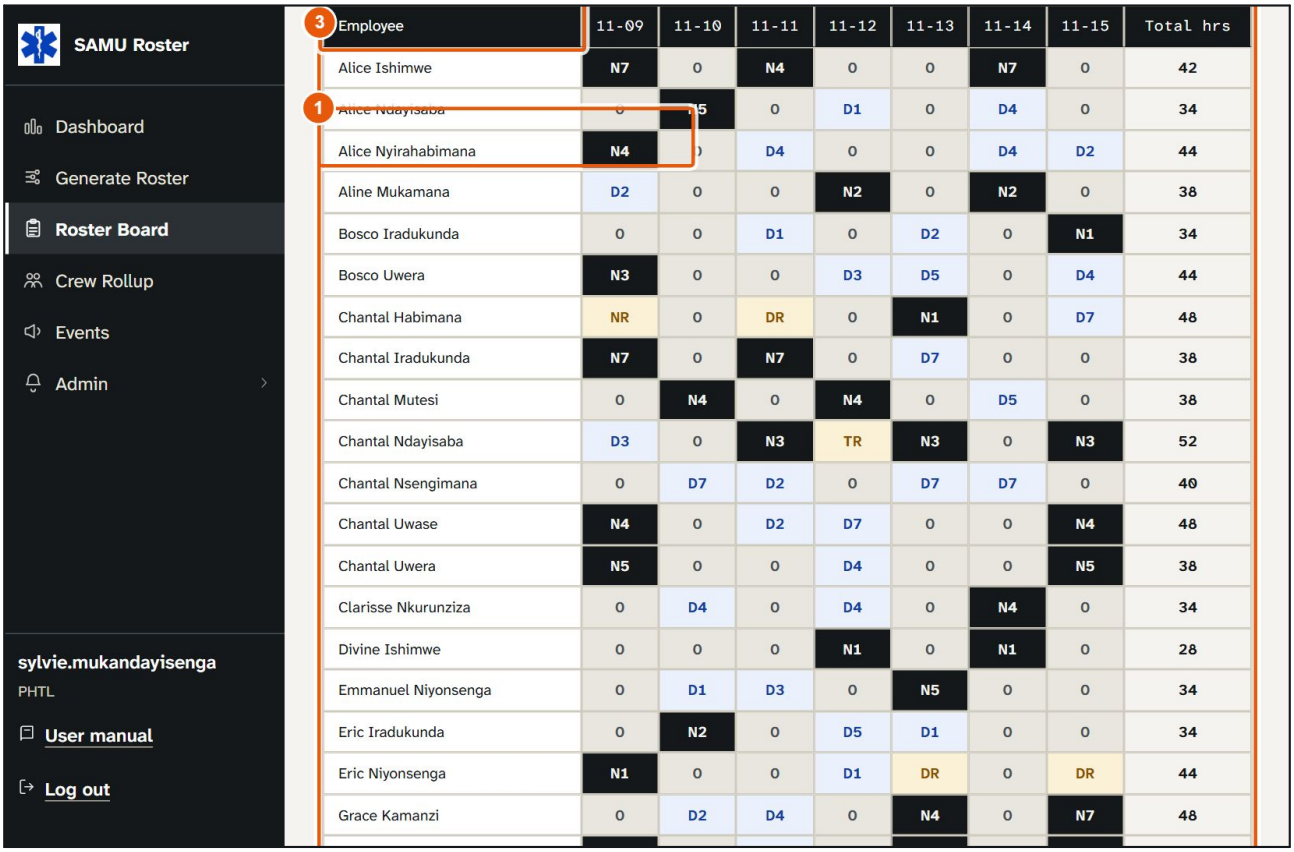
1	Each message shows what happened and when.
2	Press Mark read once you have seen it.

Reading the roster board

The board has one row per person and one column per day. Each cell holds a code. Blue-tinted cells are day shifts, dark cells are night shifts, grey cells are days off, amber cells are leave or other absence, green cells are event duty.

The Roster Board

One row per person and one column per day. Each cell holds a shift code.



1	Choose the roster. The status (draft, submitted or published) is shown below.
2	The grid: blue cells are day shifts, dark cells night shifts, grey cells days off, amber cells leave.
3	Scroll sideways to see every day. The name column stays in place.

Code	Meaning
D + number (D3)	Day shift at the station with that code
N + number (N3)	Night shift at the station with that code
DR / NR	Day / night shift at the Regulation desk (call centre desk)
DE / NE	Day / night event duty
O	Off
AL, SL, ML, PL	Annual leave, sick leave, maternity leave, paternity leave
TR, AD, P	Training, administration, permission
MS, ST, CY, CL	Mission, stock, cyclism, circumstance leave
DT, DM, DC, R	Data, day meeting, day checking, roster
SB	Standby

For fairness, a day shift counts as **10 hours** and a night shift as **14 hours**. The total at the right of each row is the hours worked in the roster.

Rules the system applies when it builds a roster

- One shift per person per day. Leave is respected exactly as entered.
- The day after a night shift is a day off. A day shift is never placed directly before a night shift.
- No more than **2 working days in a row**. These rest rules also continue across the border between two consecutive rosters.
- People marked as unable to work nights never get night shifts.
- Anesthesiologists and critical-care staff work only at the four middle-site stations and are the only medical staff the Regulation desk draws from.
- Every crew should have at least one Pro. If people are short, the system fills what it can and reports the gap; it never refuses to build a roster.
- Hours are balanced fairly across the whole calendar month, not only inside one roster.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
Sign-in is refused	Check the username (capital letters, spaces) and password. After 5 wrong tries, wait 15 minutes.
'Session expired - please log in again'	You were signed in for more than 12 hours. Sign in again.
'Waiting for another generation to finish'	Only one roster is built at a time. Keep the page open or come back later.
Generation seems to take very long	A full roster takes about 10 to 15 minutes. If the page was closed or the system restarted, start it again.
'Would leave this crew with no Pro-rated member'	Pick a Pro as the replacement, or use an override with a written justification.
A crew is short	Replace someone, or approve the crew to run short (reason and justification required).
'Can't be regenerated (status submitted/published)'	The roster is locked. Ask the administrator to reopen a submitted one.
Anything else	Tell the administrator the screen name, what you pressed and the exact message.

Who to contact

	Name and phone (fill in)
Administrator	
Your own manager	